

WELCOME TO THE FLAVORFUL WORLD OF KERALA

Kerala Traditional Foods

A Journey Through the Flavors of God's Own Country



Appam with Stew

A soft and fluffy pancake made from fermented rice batter, served with a creamy coconut-based stew.

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Puttu and Kadala

Steamed cylinders of ground rice layered with coconut, typically served with a spicy black chickpea curry.

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Karimeen Pollichathu

Pearl spot fish marinated in spices, wrapped in banana leaves, and pan-fried to perfection.

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Palada Payasam

A sweet and rich dessert made with rice flakes, milk, and sugar, flavored with cardamom.

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Kerala Beef Fry

Tender chunks of beef slow-roasted with aromatic spices, coconut slices, and curry leaves.

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Malabar Biryani

A flavorful and fragrant biriyani made with short-grain kaima rice, meat, and traditional spices.

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Erissery

A traditional curry made with pumpkin, cowpeas, and a roasted coconut paste.

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Avial

A thick mixture of various vegetables and coconut, seasoned with coconut oil and curry leaves.

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Pazham Pori

Sweet ripe plantains coated in a seasoned flour batter and deep-fried to a golden crisp.

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Kerala Parotta

A flaky, layered flatbread made from maida, popular across the state for its soft and crispy texture.

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Appam with Stew

Appam with Stew is arguably one of the most famous and beloved traditional dishes in Kerala. Appam is a type of pancake made from fermented rice batter and coconut milk. The edges are delightfully crisp, while the center remains soft, fluffy, and slightly sweet.

It is almost always paired with Ishtu or Stew, which can be made with vegetables, chicken, or mutton. The vegetable stew is a creamy, aromatic curry made with potatoes, carrots, green peas, and beans, all gently simmered in a rich coconut milk base.



Puttu and Kadala

Puttu is an iconic breakfast dish of Kerala, consisting of steamed cylinders of ground rice layered with fresh grated coconut. It's often made in a special cylindrical steamer known as a 'puttu kutti'.

The classic accompaniment to puttu is Kadala Curry, a spicy and robust dish made with black chickpeas, roasted coconut gravy, and aromatic Kerala spices. The contrast between the soft, mild puttu and the fiery, flavorful curry makes it an irresistible combination.



Karimeen Pollichathu

Karimeen, or Pearl Spot fish, is the state fish of Kerala and a staple of the backwaters. In Karimeen Pollichathu, the fish is marinated in a vibrant mixture of lemon juice, red chilies, turmeric, and other local spices.

It is then wrapped snugly in fresh banana leaves and pan-roasted or grilled. The banana leaf imparts a unique, earthy aroma to the fish, while keeping the flesh incredibly moist and flavorful. This is a must-try dish for seafood lovers.



Palada Payasam

A traditional Kerala feast (Sadya) is never complete without a serving of Palada Payasam. It is a sweet, rich, and creamy dessert that holds a special place in Kerala cuisine, especially during festivals like Onam.

It is made by simmering Ada (rice flakes) in a sweet reduction of milk and sugar until it reaches a beautiful pinkish hue. The dessert is subtly flavored with cardamom and generously garnished with ghee-roasted cashews and raisins.



Kerala Beef Fry

Kerala Beef Fry, often called 'Beef Ularthiyathu', is a legendary dish characterized by its dark, caramelized appearance and explosive flavors. It consists of tender chunks of beef that are slow-roasted over low heat.

The magic lies in the generous use of coconut oil, toasted coconut slices (thenka kothu), fresh curry leaves, and a potent blend of spices like black pepper, fennel, and coriander. It is most commonly enjoyed with flaky Kerala Parotta.



Malabar Biryani

Originating from the Malabar region of Kerala, this Biryani is distinct from its North Indian counterparts. It uses a special, highly fragrant short-grain rice called 'Khaima' or 'Jeerakasala' instead of Basmati.

The meat (chicken, mutton, or fish) is cooked separately in a rich masala, and then layered with the semi-cooked rice. The pot is sealed to trap the steam ('dum' cooking), allowing the aromatic flavors of ghee, fried onions, cashews, and spices to meld beautifully.



Erissery

Erissery is a quintessential Kerala dish, widely prepared during festivals like Onam and Vishu. It features a harmonious blend of mildly sweet vegetables like pumpkin or plantain with legumes like cowpeas.

The dish is elevated by two distinct coconut additions: a ground paste of coconut, cumin, and garlic cooked with the vegetables, and a final tempering of grated coconut roasted in coconut oil until deep golden brown, adding an irresistible crunch and nutty aroma.



Avial

Avial is a highly nutritious and vibrant medley of locally available vegetables like yam, drumsticks, carrots, beans, and ash gourd. According to legend, it was invented by Bhima of the Pandavas during their exile.

The vegetables are cooked in minimal water and combined with a coarse paste of grated coconut, cumin, and green chilies. It is given a slight tang with yogurt or raw mango, and finished with a generous drizzle of fresh coconut oil and aromatic curry leaves.



Pazham Pori

Pazham Pori, also known as Ethakka Appam, is the ultimate tea-time snack in Kerala. It perfectly balances the natural sweetness of ripe Nendran plantains with a crispy, savory exterior.

Thick slices of the ripe plantain are dipped in a batter made of all-purpose flour, a pinch of turmeric for that golden color, and sugar, before being deep-fried in hot coconut oil. The result is a snack that is crispy on the outside and warm, sweet, and melting on the inside.



Kerala Parotta

Kerala Parotta, or simply 'Porotta', is a layered, flaky flatbread that has gained immense popularity across South India. Unlike North Indian parathas, it is made from Maida (refined wheat flour).

The dough is kneaded to be highly elastic, then stretched paper-thin, pleated, and rolled into a spiral before being pan-fried with generous amounts of oil or ghee. The finished parotta is crushed with the hands to separate its many crisp, tender layers, making it the perfect vehicle for soaking up rich, spicy curries.